

The Boston Globe

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THURSDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2025

Rise in prop bets sets off alarms on gambling addiction

Scandals could compromise leagues' integrity

By Joey Flechas
GLOBE STAFF

Bryan Biehl quietly lost \$10,000 in just a few minutes tapping on his smartphone during a break at work. A pharmacist with an otherwise comfortable life in Pennsylvania, he was at the height of his addiction in early December when he placed quick wagers on several points in a tennis match, so-called prop bets that have become hugely popular on mobile sports bet-

ting apps.

"I didn't even blink an eye," he said. "That could be life-changing money to some people, and I was just so caught up in betting on a point in a tennis match that I couldn't even see the reality?"

Biehl estimates he lost more than a half-million dollars on gambling over more than a decade, with most of those losses during an explosion of sports betting in 2023 and 2024. He said his spiral into addiction accelerated after online sports betting apps began allowing prop bets, in-game wagers on an endless menu of individual events

GAMBLING, Page A7

With tree tradition, a new resonance

Wu looks to cement US-Canada ties

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

LUNENBURG, Nova Scotia — The tree started as a gift from a neighbor, and that's how it will end.

And in the handoff from one to the other — perhaps inevitably for these times — came a jab at a shared political foe.

Claire and Ronald Feener planted the white spruce in their front lawn in this coastal Canadian town more than 40 years ago, after a neighbor gave them a sapling that stood less than a foot tall.

Now a 45-foot giant, the tree is scheduled to arrive in Boston on Tuesday to be the centerpiece of the city's Christmas decorations, extending a decades-old tradition of Nova Scotia thanking Boston for its swift help after the 1917 explosion in the capital city of Halifax that killed roughly 2,000 people.

The warm exchange endures despite the White House's frosty relationship with Canada, and this year came with a twist: Michelle Wu, who has emerged as a prominent critic of

TREE, Page A7

By some measures, Boston has the most competitive rental market in the nation, according to a new report. **D1.**

Military personnel taking part in strikes on alleged drug-traf-

ficking boats would not face future prosecution, a classified opinion said. **A2.**

The US Mint ended production of the penny, which has become all-but-irrelevant. **D3.**

'I'M A PATRIOT FOR LIFE'



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Former star Rob Gronkowski made his feelings known by signing a one-day contract with the team Wednesday so he could retire as a Patriot. **C3.**

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Here's the wind up

Thursday: Still blowing.
High 48-53. Low 34-39.

Friday: More of the same.
High 43-48. Low 31-36.

Sunrise: 6:33 Sunset: 4:24

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

After 43 days in which **594,048** federal workers were furloughed, **42 million** low income and disabled people briefly went without food aid, and the Senate voted **14 times** without success before coming to a compromise, **the longest shutdown of the US government in history** ended.



CLIFF OWEN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Federal workers stood in line Wednesday to pick up meals from World Central Kitchen.

It's over for now, anyway, but the fighting goes on

Next funding deadline less than 3 months away

By Jim Puzzanghera
and Julian E.J. Sorapuru

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — By planes, trains, automobiles, and at least one motorcycle, House lawmakers streamed back to the nation's capital to finally end the record-long federal government shutdown nightmare.

LETTER FROM WASHINGTON

But don't exhale just yet.

The 222-209 vote Wednesday night on legislation to reopen the government, which President Trump signed two hours later, is only a temporary reprieve.

The new funding carries most federal agencies only until Jan. 30. And after a contentious 43-day shutdown, the political atmosphere in Washington is as toxic as ever.

"It only bought peace until the end of January," lamented Representative Debbie Dingell, a Michigan Democrat.

She was among all but six House Democrats

SHUTDOWN, Page A6

Epstein emails allege Trump knew of conduct

Democrats say it raises new questions about ties

By Michael Gold

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — House Democrats on Wednesday released emails in which Jeffrey Epstein wrote that President Trump had "spent hours at my house" with one of Epstein's victims, among other messages that suggested that the convicted sex offender believed Trump knew more about his abuse than he has acknowledged.

Trump has emphatically denied any involvement in or knowledge of Epstein's sex-trafficking operation. He has said that he and Epstein, the disgraced financier who died by suicide in federal prison in 2019, were once friendly but had a falling out.

But Democrats on the House Oversight Committee said the emails, which they selected from thousands of pages of documents received by their panel, raised new questions about the relationship between the two men. In one of the messages, Epstein flatly asserted that Trump "knew about the girls," many of whom

EPSTEIN, Page A6

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